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DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

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Statewide Wayfinding Program

Guidelines | June 2008

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DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNITY
& ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT



**PA Tourism
Signing Trust**

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Regional Wayfinding Signing System Guidelines

1.1 Purpose, Authority and Authorization

1.1.1 Purpose: The purpose of these Guidelines is to establish procedures for the installation of tourist Wayfinding Signs within the State highway right-of-way within the Commonwealth. The goal is to develop a systematic network of traffic directional signs to efficiently and effectively guide the traveling public from major highway gateways to key Attractions within the designated Signing Region with the minimum number of signs. These guidelines include the eligibility requirements, design, location and installation requirements and maintenance.

1.1.2 Authority: These Guidelines are promulgated under 75 Pa. C.S. § 6125(d).

1.1.3 Authorization: Only Wayfinding Signs, which are approved by the Pennsylvania Tourism Signing Trust, may be installed within the highway right-of-way. However, the authorization of signs shall not be construed as an endorsement of the applicant's facilities.

1.2 General Definitions

The following words and terms, when used in these Guidelines have the following meanings, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise:

Administering Agency: Pennsylvania Department of Transportation or its agent.

Agreement: The document of agreement between the Participants in the Program and the Administering Agency, setting forth the terms and conditions of participation in the Program.

Arterial: A Conventional Highway identified as an 'Arterial' on the PennDOT Official Road Use Classification Maps.

Attraction: Private businesses, public facilities and agencies, non-profits and other tourism-oriented and visitor service facilities.

Attraction of Regional Significance: A commercial or non-commercial Attraction that provides definition to the Region due to its noteworthiness and name recognition outside of the Region. These Attractions are typically the most visited and/or most culturally significant in the Region.

Conventional Highway: Any free-access public highway other than a Freeway or Expressway.

DCED: Department of Community and Economic Development

Department: Pennsylvania Department of Transportation.

Expressway: A divided arterial highway for through traffic with partial control of access and with interchanges at junctions with high-volume highways. For purposes of these Guidelines, sections of Expressway with at-grade intersections will be considered "Conventional Highway" and sections of Expressway with interchanges will be considered "Freeway."

Freeway: A divided highway with full control of access to which the only means of ingress and egress is by interchange ramps.

General Public: *A service shall be deemed available to the "General Public" if it is available to anyone, at any time, without any membership or other requirements limiting use by the public at large.*

Group Mention: A listing of a category of Attractions which share a common type, theme, or geographical identity on a single Wayfinding Sign.

Guideway Route: A designated travel corridor spanning a distinct geographical area, which typically has more eligible attractions than available sign space. The guideway name is predicative of the geographical area that it spans or the entities eligible for participation in the Program that are along it. (Examples: Laurel Highway Guideway; Lincoln Highway Guideway; Kiski Valley Guideway)

Official Traffic Control Devices: Signs, signals, markings and devices consistent with 75 Pa. C.S. (relating to Vehicle Code) and PennDOT regulations, placed or erected by authority of a public body or official having jurisdiction for the purpose of regulating, warning or guiding traffic.

Off-Premise Sign: A sign which erected upon private property that is not contiguous with the parcel where the Attraction is located and includes at a minimum the name of the Attraction.

On-Premise Sign: A sign which is erected upon the same real property that the Attraction is located and includes at a minimum the name of the Attraction.

Participant: An eligible business entity that is issued a permit by the Administering Agency for Wayfinding Signs.

PennDOT: Pennsylvania Department of Transportation

Program: The Wayfinding Signing System program. A highway signing system consisting of specialized tourist oriented directional signs and accessory signs used in conjunction with logo motorist service signs.

Region: See ‘Signing Region’.

Region Logo: All Resource Directional Signs larger than 36 inches will incorporate the name of the tourist region and the keystone insignia with the embedded icon in the top header panel. [Note: This section will be revised based on final design of sign.]

Regional Advisory Board: A board appointed by the Administering Agency representing a Signing Region for the purpose of advising the Trust on matters related to signing within the region to include, but not limited to developing consensus among participants, dealing with existing Tourist Oriented Directional Signs (TODS), incorporating existing Signing Districts into the Signing Region and developing potential participants. The chairperson shall be appointed by the Administering Agency.

Rural Area: Any geographic area that is not included in an Urban Area on PennDOT’s County Functional Classification Maps.

Rural Conventional Highway: Any Conventional Highway in a Rural Area.

Scoring Matrix: The tool used to evaluate an Attraction’s eligibility and ranking for a Mention on a Wayfinding Sign.

Seasonal Business: Any business which is not operated on a continuous year-round basis.

Signing District: A geographical area of which a municipal government sponsor is willing to enter into an agreement with PennDOT to coordinate, provide, install and maintain all signing authorized by and in conformance with PennDOT Publication 46 after approval by PennDOT at no cost to the Department.

Signing Region: One of seven geographical areas defined by the Department of Community and Economic Development as a state tourist region.

Specific Mention: A specific individual listing of an Attraction on a single Wayfinding Sign.

Sub-Region: A geographic area defined by the Department of Community and Economic Development that is part of a Signing Region which constitutes a generally recognized district.

Tourist Oriented Directional Signs (TODS): A small directional sign (Federal Designation D7-4) with white legend on blue or brown background that indicates the name of, and gives directional guidance to Attractions. These signs are located by individual Attraction(s), following PennDOT's TODS Signing Policy, and are not part of a larger signing system.

Urban Area: Any geographic area designated as an Urban Area on PennDOT's County Functional Classification Maps.

Urban Conventional Highway: Any Conventional Highway in an Urban Area.

Wayfinding Sign: A unique directional sign that functions as a Tourist Oriented Directional Sign but may include regional and sub-regional information and logos.

1.3 Evaluation of Eligibility

In order to determine an Attraction's eligibility to be included into the Wayfinding Signing System, an Attraction first must meet general eligibility requirements and qualify by type, then it must meet eligibility standards (evaluated through the Scoring Matrix, Section 1.16). A determination of eligibility does not guarantee that the Attraction will be signed.

1.3.1 General Eligibility Requirements: The following general criteria must be met by all Attractions in order to be eligible for inclusion in the Wayfinding Signing System.

- (a) **General:** The Attraction shall be open to all persons regardless of race, color, religion, ancestry, national origin, sex, age or handicap; be neat, clean and pleasing in appearance; be maintained in good repair; and comply with all Federal, State and local regulations and statutes for public accommodations concerning health, sanitation and safety.
- (b) **Admission Charges:** If a general admission is charged, it shall be collected upon entry and other charges shall be clearly displayed, at the place of entry, as to be readily visible.
- (c) **Annual Attendance:** There is no minimum annual attendance requirement. No Attraction shall be excluded from participating in the Wayfinding Signing System solely on the basis of attendance.
- (d) **Road System:** The location of the Attraction shall not require motorist to perform any illegal movements, and the roads shall be capable of handling the anticipated traffic volume and types of traffic. Motorists shall be able to readily return to the highway and proceed in the original direction of travel after visiting the Attraction. This may result in the Attraction being required to install signing to guide the motorist to their original direction of travel.
- (e) **Parking Accommodations:** The Attraction shall have adequate on-premise parking for the particular use or have available public or legal permitted on-street parking for patrons.
- (f) **Hours of Operation:** Attractions other than arenas, schools, colleges/universities, fairgrounds, and religious sites shall maintain regular hours and schedules and be open to the General Public for a minimum of 30 days per calendar year.

- (g) **Other Signs:** Wayfinding Signs shall not be authorized along the same highway approach if the applicable Attraction has an Off-Premise Sign within 2,500 feet of the applicable Wayfinding Sign. In addition, no other type of previously approved destination signing should remain in place for any destination, within the right-of-way.
- (h) **Sufficient Space:** Sufficient space exists in accordance with Sections 1.5.1, 1.5.2, 1.6.2 and 1.9 to be mentioned on signs at all locations along the route to the Attraction where a turn is required in order to provide for route continuity.
- (i) **On-Premise Sign:** The Attraction shall have an On-Premise Sign that is readily visible from the highway.
- (j) **Route Continuity:** Signs shall be installed in advance of all necessary turns, subsequent to the initial sign installation. If a sign is required on a local roadway between a state highway and the Attraction, the local authorities must approve the installation of the sign, prior to the installation of any, more distant signs on state highway.

1.3.2 Eligible Types of Attractions:

- (a) Any facility deemed appropriate by the Tourism Signing Trust or meeting the requirements of the definitions listed below.

- (b) **Commercial Attractions**

Amusement Parks: A permanent facility that may include structures and buildings, where there are multiple devices for entertainment, including rides, booths for the conduct of games, or sale of items, buildings for shows and entertainment, and restaurants and souvenir sales.

Brewery: A licensed site which shall be open to the General Public for tours, tasting and sales, a minimum of 1,500 hours per year, and provide an educational format for informing visitors about beer and beer processing.

Caverns and Other Unique Natural Areas: A naturally occurring area or site of interest to the General Public. May include caverns, waterfalls, caves, or special rock formations.

Commerce Park: A group of small business facilities, at least 25 acres in size, recognized and signed as a commerce park by the local authorities.

Drive-In Theatre: An outdoor facility for the public showing of movies projected onto at least one large screen for viewing by patrons from their vehicles. Facility shall operate at least 30 days per year, have a concession area open during show times and provide restrooms with running water and flush toilets.

Facility, Tour Location: A facility such as a plant, factory or institution which conducts daily or weekly public tours on a regularly scheduled basis year round.

Gaming Entity: A facility licensed under Act 71 – 2004, Amending Title 4 (Amusements) Pa C.S. which authorizes certain gaming sites.

Off-Track Betting Facility: A facility which provides off-premise wagering as authorized by Act 1988-127.

Racetracks and Speedways: A permanent facility used for the primary purpose of presenting organized horse or automobile racing events.

Roadside Farm Market: A stationary retail sales establishment operated by one or more farmers for the purpose of selling farm and food products directly to consumers. Operations by which the consumer harvests their own farm or food products shall be considered roadside farm markets. Roadside farm markets shall be open at least two days per week throughout the harvest season or year.

Specialty Shopping District:

Antique/Craft/Flea Market: An establishment or group of establishments comprised of shops/vendors that specialize in the sale of antiques, crafts or flea market items. A group of 1 to 5 such establishments must have at least 2,400 square feet of retail space.

Shopping Center: A group of 30 or more retail stores in a traditional shopping center or mall.

Specialty Shops: A group of 5 or more specialty shops/vendors that offer goods or services of unique interest to tourists or whose structures have a prevalent architectural style of interest to tourists and which derives a major portion of its income during the normal business season from motorists that do not reside in the immediate area as recommended by the local Tourist Promotion Agency. The goods or services shall be readily available to tourists without the need for scheduling appointments or return visits.

Town Shopping Area: An area in a town or village, that includes 5 or more retail shops including at least one specialty shop and includes other public service facilities or destinations such as libraries, museums courthouses, etc. The area should have a prevalent architectural style of interest to tourists, or must be recommended by the local Tourist Promotion Agency as being of representative of the tourism theme of the region.

Winery: A licensed site which produces a maximum of 200,000 gallons of wine per year. Sites shall maintain a minimum of 3,000 vines or 5 acres of vineyard in the Commonwealth; be open to the General Public for tours, tasting and sales, a minimum of 1,500 hours per year, and provide an educational format for informing visitors about wine and wine processing.

Zoos, Zoological Gardens and Animal Parks: A place where animals are kept, often in combination of indoor and outdoor spaces. Must have facilities which are open to the General Public.

(c) Cultural/Institutional

Arenas: Includes stadiums, expo centers, auditoriums and civic or convention centers.

Business District: An area within a city or borough which is officially designated as a business district by the local officials.

College or University: An educational institution that is nationally accredited and grants degrees.

Courthouses/Government Buildings: A public building, structure, or complex used by a Federal, County, State or municipal government for the purpose of convening official legal activities.

Fairgrounds: Includes county and state fairgrounds.

Library: A repository for literary and artistic materials, such as books, periodicals, newspapers, recordings, films, and electronic media, kept and systemically arranged for use and reference.

Military Base: A facility operated by the State or Federal government for training or support of military troops, or for inventorying and warehousing military equipment.

Museums: A facility in which works of artistic, historical, or scientific value are cared for and exhibited to the General Public.

Observatory: A facility designed and equipped to observe astronomical, meteorological or other natural phenomena.

Religious Site: A shrine, grotto or similar type site, which is of a unique religious nature. The facility must have a minimum average of 20 visitors per day on the busiest day of the week.

Theaters and Performing Arts Centers: A facility for the performing arts, exhibits, or concerts, which has a minimum occupancy capacity of 150 people.

(d) Historical/Architectural

Historic Site: A structure or place of historical, archaeological or architectural significance listed on or eligible for listing on the National Register of Historic Places maintained by the U.S. Department of Interior or otherwise designated by the Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission (PHMC), or a County Historical Commission or Agency. The site must be accessible to the General Public and provide a place where visitors can obtain information about the historic site.

Historic Sites may include the following types, provided they meet the above criteria:

- > Encampments and Battlefields
- > Forts
- > Houses
- > Commercial buildings
- > Farms, farmsteads and barns
- > Religious sites, places of worship, cemeteries and monuments
- > Mills and factories
- > Furnaces
- > Coal mines and coke ovens
- > Bridges
- > Tollhouses
- > Canals
- > Railroad Stations
- > Cemeteries

Historic District: A district or zone listed on or eligible for listing on the National Register of Historic Places maintained by the U.S. Department of Interior or otherwise designated by the Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission (PHMC), or a County Historical Commission or Agency. Historic districts shall provide the General Public with a single, central location such as a self-service kiosk or welcome center, where visitors can obtain information concerning the historic district.

Historic Districts may include the following:

- > Historic residential streets
- > Shopping streets and districts
- > Court houses and public buildings
- > Railroad line
- > Canal

(e) **Recreational**

Boat Launch: A public facility for the docking or launching of boats.

Campground: A facility with continuous operation for at least 6 months per year and a minimum of 20 overnight sites. An attendant shall be available during the hours of operations and rest rooms with showers, running water and flush toilets shall be available. Accommodations sold on annual or time-sharing basis or otherwise not available for General Public use will not be counted toward the minimum requirements.

Canoeing and Rafting: Public areas with established canoeing and rafting facilities.

Golf Courses: Facilities open to the public and offering at least nine (9) holes of play. Miniature golf courses, driving ranges, chip and putt courses, and indoor golf shall also be eligible.

Hiking and Biking Trails/Routes: Areas designated for recreational hiking, biking, walking, etc. which are publicly accessible, and owned and maintained by either the Local or County government or Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources, or non-profit organizations. Signs will only be installed at locations that direct the motorist to an established trail head with parking facilities.

Horseback Riding Areas: Areas designated for horseback/ponyback riding for the General Public.

Hunting and Fishing Areas: Areas so designated and under the jurisdiction of the Pennsylvania Game Commission or the Pennsylvania Fish and Boat Commission.

National, State and Regional Parks and Forests: An area so designated and under the jurisdiction of the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources, Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission (PHMC), National Park Service, and U.S. Department of the Interior, County Government, or non-profit organization with facilities open to the General Public.

Ski Areas: A downhill with equipment rentals or cross-country ski area with equipment rentals and minimum of five (5) miles of marked and groomed trails.

Snowmobile Trails and Winter Sports Areas (excluding Ski Areas): Areas with marked snowmobile trails, ice skating rinks, snowboarding, sleigh rides, and toboggan runs, which are open to the General Public. Signs will only be installed at locations that direct the motorist to an established trail head with parking facilities.

Sports Facilities: Regional (multi-jurisdictional) facilities such as minor league and little league baseball fields, and school recreational fields.

Water Skiing: Areas designated for water skiing, jet skiing, or motorboats.

(f) **Tourist Services**

Bed and Breakfasts: A private residence located in a Rural Area that contains ten (10) or fewer bedrooms used for providing overnight accommodations to the public, and which breakfast is the only meal served and is included in the charge for the room. Must be rated in accordance with a national or state standards for bed and breakfasts; rating may be performed by the local Tourist Promotion Agency.

Country Inn: A facility located in a Rural Area that contains 25 or fewer rooms for providing overnight lodging accommodations to the public, and that at a minimum provides full service dining for morning and evening meals. Must be rated in accordance with a national or state standards for country inns; rating may be performed by the local Tourist Promotion Agency.

Historic Hotel: A facility which must be located within a building that is at least 50 years of age; and be listed on or eligible for listing on the National Register of Historic Places, or which is recognized by State, National or a County Historical Society as having historical significance; and currently holds itself out by any means, including advertising, license, registration with any innkeepers' group, convention listing association, travel publication or similar association or with any government agency, as being available to provide overnight lodging or use of facility space for considerations to persons seeking temporary accommodations.

Hospitals: An institution located within the designated urban area providing primary health services and medical or surgical care to persons, primary inpatients, suffering from illness, disease, injury, deformity and other abnormal physical or mental conditions. The facility must have 24-hour emergency care with a doctor on duty at all times.

Resort: A facility with at least 75 rooms where the primary attraction is generally recreational features and activities that are the main focal point of a vacation.

Regional Restaurant: An establishment in a Rural Area where food and drink are prepared, served and consumed on premise and provided by waiter service. The facility must provide a minimum of twenty (20) indoor seats. Must be a local operation uniquely associated to the region. Drive-through only establishments and franchised or corporate-owned chain restaurants are excluded from this type of eligible attractions.

Pennsylvania Visitor Information Centers: A facility where the primary purpose of its operation is to provide, information and tourist supportive services. Must be approved by the Department of Community and Economic Development.

(g) Transportation Related

Airports: A public use facility licensed by the Pennsylvania Department of Transportation for landing and takeoff of aircraft, and for receiving and discharging passengers and cargo.

Heritage Roads, Historic Routes, Byways or Trails: A road, trail, or route designated by the Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR), PennDOT, U.S. Department of the Interior, or other Federal agency as being part of a national or state recognized historic or heritage park, trail system, or byway.

Railroad Trips: Scenic or historic railroad trips recognized by the local Chamber of Commerce, the regional Tourist Promotion Agency, Pennsylvania Department of Conservation and Natural Resources, or Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission.

Railroad/Bus Stations: A passenger terminal utilized for discharging and picking up passengers and ticketing.

Scenic Overlook: An area, usually at the side of the road, where persons can observe a scenic area such as significant geology, unique botanical resources, or across expanses of land such as farmlands, woodlands, or across mountaintops or ridges.

Water Tours: A guided tour on a body of water using a passenger carrying vessel with access to a docking facility and adequate legal parking.

Waterfronts: Areas with access to and views of the rivers of the Commonwealth, which are recognized by the County or State as having significant recreational or cultural value and are open a minimum of 30 days per calendar year.

1.3.3 Scoring Matrix and Ranking: In order for an Attraction to be eligible to be included in the Wayfinding Signing System, it must have a minimum score of 50 points, as determined through an evaluation using the Scoring Matrix in Section 1.16.

1.4 System Design

1.4.1 General: A Wayfinding Signing System is to provide geographical guidance by taking advantage of known traffic patterns, major tourist generators and primary arterial highways. It incorporates the official state tourism branding consisting of a regional icon within a keystone to integrate the system into an overall tourism marketing program, build brand equity, and provide the consumer with a consistent icon. It replaces signing each Attraction on an individual basis with a systematic process of signing visitors in a logical sequence. Region Welcome, Guideway, and Resource Directional signs shall be used as steps to guide visitors into and through the region to participating destinations. In the process, a Region's most prominent features and resources are called out and promoted, but only as required to serve visitor guidance. In general, individual Attractions receive fewer signs, but the Region and Attractions overall gain a comprehensive and consistent system of signing that makes the whole Region more accessible. Wayfinding Sign messaging and placement shall generally be designed to provide specific guidance to Attractions at their nearest turn while continuing to provide generalized guidance toward more distant Attractions or groups of Attractions. *[Note: This section will be adjusted based on the final sign design.]*

1.4.2 Wayfinding Sign Types: The following is a summary of the types of signs and their use in the Wayfinding Signing System:

- (a) **Welcome Sign:** A sign used on Conventional Highways at or near the border of the Region which introduces the motorist to the regional logo type and signing system. These signs may be installed on numbered U.S. or Pennsylvania traffic routes that are Primary Corridors in the Region, that is, a corridor which provides a primary access to key Attractions in the Region. These signs may also be installed on other Conventional Highways at or near the Region boundary.
- (b) **Sub-region Welcome Sign:** A sign used on Conventional Highways at or near the border of the Sub-region which introduces the motorist to the sub-region. It is only authorized for sub-regions officially recognized by the Tourism Signing Trust.
- (c) **Guideway Marker:** A sign used to designate a travel corridor spanning as a Guideway. Guideway markers are to be placed at or immediately after key intersections to confirm Region and route continuity and at intervals not to exceed 10 miles.
- (d) **Resource Directional Sign:** This sign provides directions to specific Attractions or grouped categories of Attractions. Resource Directional Signs shall be installed in advance of required turns to the Attraction or grouped category of Attractions.
- (e) **General Motorist and Standard Symbol Signs:** Standard symbols may also be used, in lieu of or in addition to, providing a grouped mention at the discretion of the Trust.

1.5 Location and Spacing

1.5.1 Location: Signs shall not be installed immediately in advance of the Attraction, along the highway from which the entrance is accessed, unless the entrance is visually obscured, in the direction of travel. Unless approved by the Administering Agency, all signs shall be installed to the right of the direction of travel, and where sufficient space is available.

- (a) Signs should be located to take advantage of natural terrain, to minimize the impacts on the scenic environment and to avoid visual conflict with other signs within the highway right-of-way.
- (b) When an at-grade intersection is replaced with an interchange, the Administering Agency reserves the right, to relocate, eliminate or alter all displaced and affected signs in order to best maintain continuity of the overall highway signing system. All changes are subject to approval by PennDOT.
- (c) Signs shall be located so as not to interfere with, obstruct or divert drivers' attention from any other Official Traffic Control Device. Other Official Traffic Control Devices placed at intersection approaches, subsequent to the placement of a Wayfinding Sign, shall have precedence as to location and may require the relocation of the Wayfinding Sign. In the locations where Official Traffic Control Devices are integrated into the Wayfinding Signing System, the Official Traffic Control Devices shall take precedence, with regard to order, space and location, over other information.
- (d) Wayfinding Signs should be positioned in such a manner that does not restrict drivers' attention when entering the highway from side roads or driveways.

1.5.2 Spacing: Wayfinding Signs shall be located not less than 200 feet nor more than 1,320 feet in advance of a location where a turn is required from the highway. At intersections where more than one Wayfinding Sign is required, the minimum spacing between such assemblies should be 200 feet. Minimum spacing between a Wayfinding Sign and another Official Traffic Control Device shall be 100 feet. The maximum number of Wayfinding Signs at an intersection on each approach shall be two.

1.6 Sign Design *[This section will be revised based on final sign design.]*

1.6.1 Design:

- (a) Sign Panel layouts shall be as follows: *[figures will be inserted]*
 - (1) Welcome Sign – Figure
 - (2) Sub-region Welcome Sign - Figure
 - (3) Guideway Marker Sign – Figure
 - (4) Resource Directional Sign Standard – Figure
 - (5) Resource Directional Sign – Vertical – Figure
- (b) The background color for region designation area shall be highway blue with white letter for the region name. The keystone shall be highway yellow with the icon in white. The arch may be fabricated by either using non-reflective vinyl on a rectangular background or fabricating the aluminum substrate to the specific shape of the sign and attaching the keystone separately.

The background colors for the specific mentions will be highway blue although highway brown may be used for recreational and historical destinations.
- (c) The Sub-regional Logo shall be approved by the Department of Community and Economic Development and shall be consistent in appearance with all Resource Directional signs.
- (d) Each Resource Directional Sign Mention shall be limited to a maximum of two (2) lines. The Mention is limited to the name of the Attraction or group of Attractions or an abbreviation thereof. No additional promotional information shall be allowed on any sign type.

- (e) The Administering Agency, with approval from the Department, shall maintain all standards for panel size, color, and construction for the entire system, in order to insure continuity and uniformity. On roads with a posted speed limit greater than 40 mph, legend height shall be 6". On roads with a posted speed limit of 40 mph or under, legend height shall be 4". Variance may be approved by the Department due to circumstances such as restricted right-of-way.
- (f) On multi-lane highways, a supplemental directional message such as "left lane," etc., may be utilized at the discretion of the Administering Agency. The supplemental message is typically mounted below the panel and shall be black legend on yellow reflectorized background with all upper case letter height 0.75 x the upper case letter height of the panel it is supplementing.
- (g) General Motorist and Standard Symbol signs approved for use in the Federal Standards Highway Signs book. Examples are: "Camping," "Hiking," "Biking Trail," or "Visitor Information."
- (h) In rural areas, Standard Resource Directional Signs shall be used when possible instead of the Vertical Resource Directional Sign. In Urban areas, the Vertical Resource Directional Sign is preferred. The colors will include highway blue, white and brown.
- (i) Type III retro-reflective sheeting shall be used on all sign panels. Floodcoating with transparent inks or transparent overlay films may be used.
- (j) The typeface shall be Clearview.

1.6.2 Arrangement:

- (a) A maximum of three (3) Mentions shall be allowed on any Wayfinding Sign.
- (b) The order of directional panels on a single Wayfinding Sign structure shall be the straight-ahead is always located above the left or right turn, and the left turn is always located above the right turn. The order of multiple Wayfinding Sign installations on an approach shall be, in the direction of travel, left-turn sign prior to right-turn or straight-ahead sign, and right-turn sign prior to straight-ahead sign.
- (c) If more than one Attraction exists on a Wayfinding Sign, the order of Mentions shall be that those that are nearest will be located above those that are farther away.

1.6.3 Coordination with Other Sign Systems:

- (a) **Treatment of Request for New TODS:** No new requests for traditional TODS will be accepted by the Department.
- (b) **Treatment of Existing Traditional TODS:**
 - (1) All traditional TODS within a county where wayfinding signs are installed will be removed upon completion of the wayfinding sign installation.
 - (2) Existing traditional TODS that serve as trailblazer signs in the PA Logo Signing Program should be replaced with signs that conform to the Regional Signing Program design. The TODS replacements shall be coordinated with the Administrator of the PA Logo Signing Program.

1.7 Application

1.7.1 Application:

- (a) Any potential Attraction must work through the appropriate Regional Advisory Board for inclusion in the preliminary regional signing plan associated with a new wayfinding. The Administrative Agency will make final determination on eligibility.
- (b) Once included in the preliminary regional signing plan, Attractions shall obtain and complete an application form to be provided by the Administering Agency. Visit www.palogo.org to review a sample application. The Attraction shall attest to the accuracy of all information provided on the application and shall return it to the Administering Agency, who shall make a determination of eligibility and the ability for signs to be installed for the Attraction in accordance with these Guidelines. The Attraction shall be notified in writing regarding their eligibility for the Program and specific about the potential location(s) and types of mentions. Details about the Program and cost will be explained to the eligible businesses by the Administering Agency.

Refer to Section 1.8 regarding Agreement, Sign Installation, Cost and Maintenance.

1.7.2 Resource Directional Sign Space Allocation:

- (a) **Specific Mention:** Approved Attractions shall be able to create a signed trail with Specific Mentions starting with a Resource Directional Sign facing each direction along the nearest designated Arterial or Guideway, if and only if, space for Resource Directional Signs is available in advance of every turn required for travelers from the turn off of the nearest designated Arterial or Guideway to the entrance of the entity.

Attractions whose entrance is located on an Arterial or Guideway may also be signed from crossing Arterials or Guideways on both sides of the Attraction (north and south or east and west) provided the Attraction is signed from the nearest crossing Arterial or Guideway.

- (b) **Group-Mention (grouped by theme, type, or geographical clustering):** At a common sign location where approved Attractions share a common type, theme or geographical identity, the Administering Agency may require the attractions to be combined into a single Group-Mention.

Examples of Group-Mentions:

- > Ski Resorts
- > Whitewater Rafting
- > Downtown Destinations
- > Historic Downtown
- > Shopping District/Strip/Centers
- > Main Campus/South Campus
- > State Parks
- > Government Buildings
- > Museums/Theaters
- > Sports Stadiums
- > North Shore/South Side
- > Historic Sites

- (c) **Attractions of Regional Significance (RS-Attractions):** The Regional Advisory Boards shall identify and list Attractions in the Region to be included in the preliminary regional signing plan to be submitted to the Administering Agency. The preliminary regional signing plan will include those Attractions designated as Attractions of Regional Significance.

Attractions designated as RS-Attractions may start signed trails to their entrances from not more than the four nearest Guideways or designated Arterials. Signing for RS-Attractions shall take precedence over signing for standard Attractions. The Administering Agency may require combination into Grouped-Mentions for RS-Attractions with other RS-Attractions or for RS-Attractions with standard Attractions where these Attractions share a common theme, type or geographical identity.

1.7.3 Excess Sign Loading:

The following procedures shall be followed when all available sign space at a given location has been allocated and additional Attractions desire Wayfinding Signing.

- (a) When a Resource Directional Sign is filled with Specific Mentions, and a new Specific Mention is applied for and approved, the Administering Agency may replace a Specific Mention with a Group-Mention if any two attractions share a common type theme or geographical identity.
- (b) If none of the Attractions may be combined into a Grouped-Mention, the Administering Agency may elect to review the point totals received by the existing and prospective Participants and assign the sign space based on the highest point total.

1.8 Agreement, Sign Installation, Cost and Maintenance

1.8.1 Agreement: An eligible Attraction that wishes to participate in the Program, shall enter into an “Agreement” with the Administering Agency and will pay specified “participation costs” as determined by the Administering Agency. Visit www.palogo.org to review the Form of Agreement.

1.8.2 Installation: The Administering Agency will be responsible for supplying and installing all signs. The design location, construction and maintenance of all Wayfinding TODS shall be the responsibility of the Administering Agency,

1.8.3 Participation Costs: Each applicant shall be responsible for the total cost of participation in the Program based on a fee structure established by the Administering Agency.

1.9 Unacceptable Locations for Wayfinding Signs

Wayfinding Signs shall not be authorized at the following locations or under the following circumstances:

- (a) Where an illegal movement is required to access a business.
- (b) Where long sections of structure, retaining wall and/or installations of noise wall or severe topography limit the ready placement of ground-mounted signing.
- (c) Where the Department determines that for safety, operational, or other explained reasons the installation of the Wayfinding Signs is not in the best interest of the traveling public.

1.10 Removal and Relocation of Signs

1.10.1 Removal of Wayfinding Signs: The Department reserves the right to remove signs if space is needed for necessary Official Traffic-Control Devices or if it is determined that they are not in the best interest of the overall system or the motoring public, as determined in conjunction with the Administering Agency.

Except where otherwise provided in this Section, Wayfinding Signs may be removed by the Administering Agency for one or more of the following reasons:

- (a) Failure to comply with eligibility set forth in Section 1.3.
- (b) If fire, accident, facility renovation, or similar causes results in a qualified Attraction becoming inoperable for a period of time exceeding 15 days, the Attraction will be given 6 months from the date of closing to complete renovations and reopen for business, provided that the Participant maintains its Wayfinding Signing Agreement in an active status by paying the annual maintenance fees in a timely fashion. If a business is closed for any purpose other than those stated above, and no assignment agreement is presented for approval at the time that the business is closed pursuant to Guideline procedures, the Agreement immediately becomes void, and all Mentions for that particular Attraction will be removed.
- (c) If the facility ceases to operate in accordance with the Wayfinding Signing System Guidelines, its Agreement with the Administering Agency is terminated, and the Attraction shall lose its right to continued participation in the Program until such time as a new application is submitted and approved.

1.10.2 Removal of Non-Wayfinding Signs: All Participants shall be required to remove all existing traditional TODS identifying that Attraction, within the boundaries of the Signing Region.

1.10.3 Relocation of Wayfinding Signs: If Department projects or operations involving maintenance, design, utilities, traffic control, drainage or construction necessitates the temporary or permanent relocation of Wayfinding Signs, the Department and/or the Administering Agency and the Department will make every effort to relocate the signs to an agreed upon location conforming with these guidelines at the Department's expense. In general, the Administering Agency will first determine: 1) if the services still meet applicable Guidelines for Wayfinding Signs, 2) if the relocation of existing Wayfinding Signs is possible, and 3) whether new (added) signs or changed signs are needed as a result of changes in routing. Access control, travel distance, existing signing and the route of return to the highway will be factors in such determination. The cost of relocating or changing existing Wayfinding Signs due to the Department initiated actions will be paid for entirely by the Department. The cost of installing new (added) Wayfinding Signs, if determined necessary per the Wayfinding Signing System Guidelines and the Department requirements, will continue to be the responsibility of the Wayfinding Signing System Participant. Agreements and cost arrangements for new (added) signs as per Section 1.8 will apply.

1.11. Changes in Participating Attractions

1.11.1 Sale or Termination of Business; Assignment: Attractions may not assign a Wayfinding Signing Trust Agreement without prior written consent of the Administering Agency, which consent shall be in the Administering Agency's sole discretion. Attractions Agreements run with the tract of land for which application was initially made and shall not be assigned to another tract of land, except if the Participant's Attraction's new location meets all of the Administering Agency's most recent applicable eligibility criteria and sufficient space exists. At that time an Addendum to the Attraction's Agreement would be executed, modifying the location of the Attraction and its Wayfinding Signs, and requiring the Attraction to pay the full

cost of any removal of existing signs deemed unnecessary and the installation of new signs, as result of the relocation. If the Attraction does not qualify for participation in the Wayfinding Signing System at its new location, the Attraction shall be removed from the Wayfinding Signing System with no refunds, since the relocation was the result of action by the Attraction alone.

1.11.2 New Attraction Participation: If a new or existing Attraction is interested in participating in the Wayfinding Signing System in an area that already has been signed, it may request to participate in the Wayfinding Signing System subject to the following:

- (a) The Attraction meets all of the eligibility criteria defined in these Guidelines.
- (b) All Mentions to be added will be done so at the discretion of the Administering Agency with regards to time, and construction coordination which is most cost effective for the Administering Agency. If an Attraction chooses to have the addition occur in a shorter period of time, it will be responsible for bearing the full premium costs incurred for the addition to all affected signs, as determined by the Administering Agency.

1.11.3 Change in Attraction Identification: If an Attraction has changed its name, it will bear the full cost of any modification to existing Wayfinding Signs. All Mentions to be changed will be done so at the discretion of the Administering Agency with regards to time, and construction coordination which is most cost-effective for the Administering Agency.

1.12. Funding and Administration

1.12.1 General: The Wayfinding Signing Program is implemented and managed by the Administering Agency as a public function on a nonprofit basis. All costs associated with the design, erection, maintenance and administration of Wayfinding Signs will be uniformly assessed to all participating Attractions. Iconic attractions (such as Scenic Overlooks) that do not have an owner should not be excluded from participation. The Wayfinding Signing Program will be administered on a non-profit basis by the Administering Agency. All Wayfinding Signs in Department right-of-way will become the property of the Department after erection and written acceptance of the installations by the Department. Wayfinding Signs located off of Department right-of-way will remain property of the Administering Agency.

1.12.2 Duties of the Administering Agency: In addition to all duties spelled out in previous sections of these Guidelines, the Administering Agency will be responsible for:

- (a) Contacting eligible Attractions for promotional purposes.
- (b) Establishing a fee schedule and entering into an Agreement with Attractions on a contractual basis.
- (c) Issuing permits and collecting fees from the Participants.
- (d) Obtaining signed compliance forms from applicants to verify Attraction eligibility.
- (e) Selecting an engineering firm to develop construction plans for the Department and for fabrication and installation purposes.
- (f) Coordinating with the Department relative to sign placement and obtain concurrence from the Department District Offices upon completion of a construction contract.
- (g) Bidding and awarding the construction project.
- (h) Inspecting and maintaining the Wayfinding Signs.

- (i) Preparing an annual report and submitting to the Department.
- (j) Administering the Wayfinding Signing Program on a day-to-day basis.

1.12.3 Audit: The Administering Agency will be responsible to perform an annual audit on a certified basis.

1.12.4 Annual Report: The Administering Agency will prepare an annual report and submit it to the Department within approximately 120 days after each fiscal year. The fiscal year will be the 12- month fiscal period utilized by the Program Administering Agency. The report shall summarize the number of attractions participating in the Wayfinding Signing Program, the fees charged for such participation, the methodology used to determine the fee amounts and the Wayfinding Signing Program’s annual financial statement.

1.13 Department Action

1.13.1 Department Responsibility. If the Wayfinding Signing Program is administered by an Administering Agency other than the Department, the Department intends to cooperate with, share file information, and provide expertise to the Administering Agency and to engineering consultants who represents the Administering Agency. The Department, through district engineering offices, will assist the Administering Agency and its design consultants in determining suitable locations for Wayfinding Signs. The Department will review all Wayfinding Signing and will accept in writing the completed Wayfinding Signs at the conclusion of construction. The Department will maintain file copies of plans prepared by the Administering Agency which show Wayfinding Sign locations. The Department will be responsible for the Wayfinding Signing Program Guidelines and regulations. The Department will conduct Quality Assurance field reviews to inspect Wayfinding Sign installations.

1.13.2 Applicant Appeal A business may appeal a denial for signing or other adverse actions under Title 2, Pa. C.S., Sections 501-508 (relating to the Administrative Agency Law), by submitting a written request for a hearing within 30 days of the date of the denial or notification. Businesses should submit appeals to:

Administrative Docket Clerk
Pennsylvania Department of Transportation
400 North Street-9th Floor
Harrisburg, PA 17120-0096

The written request shall include a filing fee made payable to the “Commonwealth of Pennsylvania” and a copy of the denial notification.

At the time of publication, filing fees are listed at 34 Pa.B. 4081 (see <http://www.pabulletin.com/secure/data/vol34/34-31/1410.html>). Filing fees for appealing a logo decision is a Level II fee, and comes under the category of “motorist information sign matters.” Businesses may verify the current fee by contacting the Administrative Docket Clerk at 717 772 2741.

1.14 Changes in Program Administration

If the Wayfinding Signing Program is administered by an Administering Agency other than the Department, and for some reason their services are terminated, all financial resources and records will become the Department’s property for use as an on-going program.

1.15 Sign Design Figures

[Sign design figures will be inserted once finalized.]

1.16 Scoring Matrix

1. Attraction of regional significance as identified by the Regional Advisory Board.

Yes	50 points
No	0 points

Score _____

2. Size of Attraction

An Attraction should report the total number of full time employees or full time equivalent for part time employees, during the Attraction's peak season. For example, an employee that works 50 percent of a normal full time employee should be counted as .5. Each Attraction should attach a copy of their most recent Pennsylvania Unemployment Compensation Form PA-UC-2. Non-profit Attractions can count volunteer staff, using the same method of equivalent calculation.

Number of Full Time Employee Equivalents

101+	25 points
51-100	20 points
11-50	15 points
<10	10 points

Score _____

3. Hours of Operation

Open 56 or more hours per week.	20 points
Open between 40 and 56 hours per week.	10 points
Open less than 40 hours per week.	5 points

Score _____

4. Adequate Road System

Paved Access Road/Entrance with clearly visible entrance signing.	10 points
Unpaved Access/Road Entrance with clearly visible entrance signing	5 points
Unclear Entrance with sign not clearly visible with 200 feet of entrance.	0 points

Score _____

5. Adequate Parking Facilities

Sufficient parking based on the Institute of Transportation Engineers Standards for Parking Generation, 1987 for the acceptable ratio of Attraction attendance capacity and parking spaces on a paved area. 15 points

Sufficient parking based on the Institute of Transportation Engineers Standards for Parking Generation, 1987 for the acceptable ratio of Attraction attendance capacity and parking spaces on an unpaved area. 10 points

Legal on-street parking or parking in municipal lots or garages within ¼ mile of Attraction. 10 points

Insufficient parking on Attraction property based on the Institute of Transportation Engineers Standards for Parking Generation, 1987, for the acceptable ratio of Attraction attendance capacity and parking spaces. 5 points

No Parking 0 points

Score _____

6. Seasonal Operation

Open 12 months per year. 20 points

Open at least 6 months per year. 15 points

Open less than 6 months per year. 5 points

Score _____

Grand Total: _____